

RedactB4X Tutorial

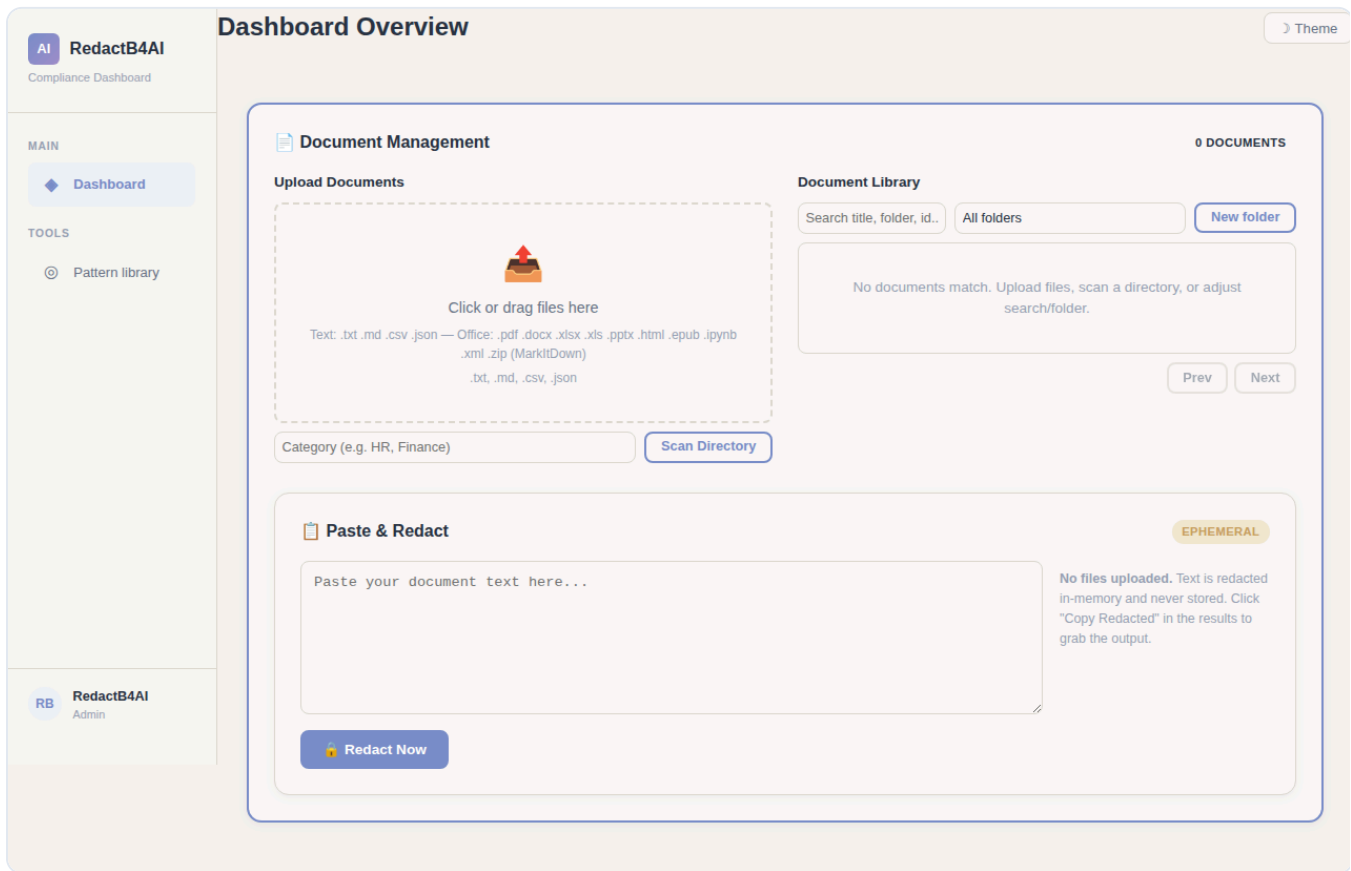
A step-by-step guide to finding and removing personal information from your documents.

RedactB4X Tutorial

A step-by-step guide to finding and removing personal information from your documents.

What This Tool Does

RedactB4X reads your documents, finds personal information (names, Social Security numbers, email addresses, and more), and replaces that information with safe placeholder tokens. You get a redacted version of your document that you can share without worrying about leaking private data.



Important

Be sure you maintain provenance of the redacted data. Do not leave it outside of the current folders where you current keep confidential data. Once you are done using it, then delete it or store it safely. With enough metadata, it could be possible to determine the redacted data.

Step 1: Add Documents

You have three ways to get documents into the system.

Option A: Drag and Drop

Open a file explorer window on your computer, select the files you want, and drag them onto the upload zone (the dashed-border area labeled "Upload Documents"). The zone will highlight when files are hovering over it.

Let go. A message will confirm how many files uploaded successfully.

Option B: Click to Browse

Click inside the upload zone. A file picker window opens. Select one or more files, then click Open.

Option C: Scan a Folder

If you have a whole folder of documents, click **Scan Directory** next to the category field. A dialog box appears.

- Type a folder path on the server (like `/home/user/documents`), or
- Click **Choose folder on this computer** and pick a folder from your machine.

Click **Scan**. The system imports every supported file it finds, preserving your folder structure. Duplicates are skipped automatically.

What Files Work?

FORMAT	NOTES
PDF (.pdf)	Converted to text automatically
Word (.docx)	Converted to text automatically
Excel (.xlsx, .xls)	Converted to text automatically
PowerPoint (.pptx)	Converted to text automatically
Text (.txt, .md, .csv, .json)	Used as-is
HTML (.html, .htm)	Converted to text automatically
EPUB (.epub)	Converted to text automatically

Step 2: Organize Your Documents

Your uploaded documents appear in the Document Library table on the right side of the dashboard.

Create Folders

Click **New folder** above the library table. Type a folder path, using forward slashes to nest folders, like `HR/Recruiting` . Click Create.

Filter and Search

- **Search bar:** type a keyword to filter documents by name, folder, or category.
- **Folder dropdown:** select a folder to show only documents in that folder and its sub-folders.

Sort Through Pages

The library shows 10 documents at a time. Use the **Prev** and **Next** buttons to move between pages.

Step 3: Process a Document (Find and Redact PII)

This is the main event. Processing runs the PII detector on a document and shows you everything it found.

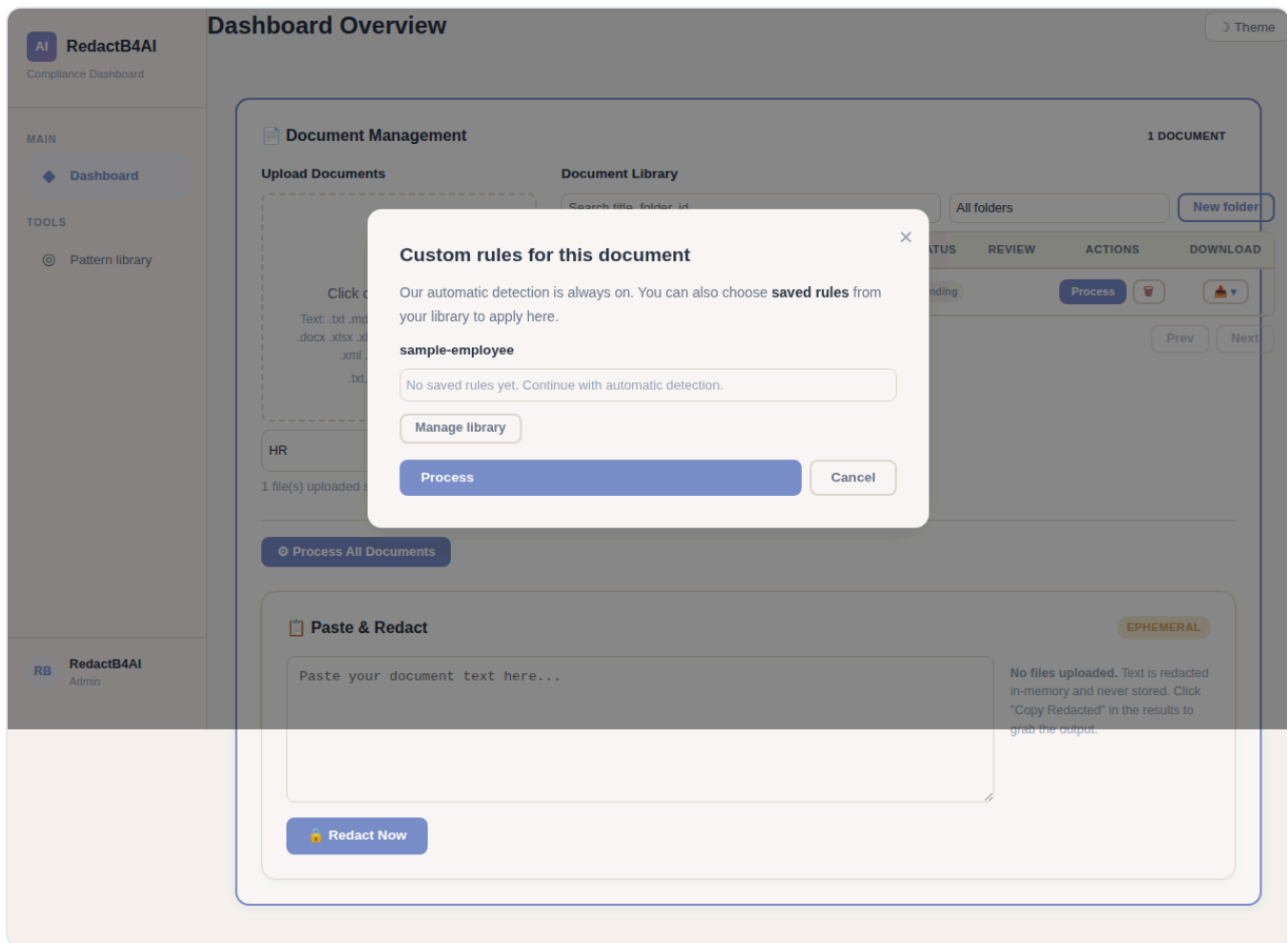
Single Document

Find the document in the library.

Click the **Process** button on that row.

A Pattern Picker modal appears. The system's built-in detection is always on. If you have saved custom rules (more on that later), you can check the ones you want to apply here.

Click **Process document**.



The Document Processing modal opens. You get three panels:

- **Left panel:** your original document text.
- **Right panel:** the redacted version, with personal information replaced by tokens like [EMAIL-a1b2c3] or [SSN-d4e5f6] .
- **PII Detection panel:** a list of every item the system found, showing the type (like "Email Address"), the original value, and the replacement token.

AI RedactB4AI

Dashboard Overview

Theme

sample-employee 5 PII FOUND

Original

ACME Corp Employee Handbook (excerpt)

Employee Record:
Name: John Doe
SSN: 123-45-6789
Email: john.doe@acme.example.com
Phone: +1-555-0123
Address: 123 Main St, Springfield, IL 62701

Emergency Contact: Jane Doe, +1-555-0456

Bank Account: 987654321, Routing: 021000021

Employee must complete security training within 30 days of hire.

Redacted PII REMOVED

ACME Corp Employee Handbook (excerpt)

Employee Record:
Name: [PERSON-6cea57]
SSN: [SSN-01a546]
Email: [EMAIL-85c52b]
Phone: +1-555-0123
Address: [ADDRESS-9421c5]

Emergency Contact: [CONTACT-15b0fd]

Bank Account: 987654321, Routing: 021000021

Employee must complete security training within 30 days of hire.

PII Detection

Found 5 PII items

PERSON NAME John Doe → [PERSON-6cea57]
SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER 123-45-6789 → [SSN-01a546]
EMAIL ADDRESS john.doe@acme.example.com → [EMAIL-85c52b]
ADDRESS 123 Main St, Springfield, IL 62701 → [ADDRESS-9421c5]
EMERGENCY CONTACT Jane Doe, +1-555-0456 → [CONTACT-15b0fd]

Review the redacted text and PII list. Approve when redaction looks complete, or flag missed items.

✓ Looks Correct — Approve & Save

Missed Something

Close

Paste your document text here...

no files uploaded. text is redacted in-memory and never stored. Click "Copy Redacted" in the results to grab the output.

Redact Now

Review the results. You have two options:

- **Looks Correct -- Approve & Save:** click this if everything looks good. The document gets an "Approved" status badge.
- **Missed Something:** click this if the system missed personal information. The Pattern Lab opens so you can fix it.

Step 4: Catch What Was Missed (Pattern Lab)

No detector is perfect. If the system missed a person's name, an address, or any other personal information, the Pattern Lab lets you tell it what to look for.

Click **Missed Something** on a processed document.

The Pattern Lab opens with your document text displayed.

Highlight (select) the text that was missed -- for example, drag your cursor over "Sarah Mitchell" in the document.

When you release, you see options:

- **Save to library & apply similar**: the system figures out the type of text you highlighted (a name, a date, a phone number, etc.) and builds a rule that catches all similar values. For example, highlighting one person's name creates a rule that finds all names in the document. This is usually what you want. -

This document only (exact): redacts just the exact text you highlighted. Good for one-off items like a company name.

You can also use the **Advanced section** for more control:

- **Suggested names**: the system compares your document against a list of known person names and shows clickable chips for any it missed. Click a name to redact it. - **Type exact text**: type any string to redact, like "Acme Corp". - **Technical regex**: enter a regular expression if you know what you are doing. The field auto-fills when a "similar" match is available.

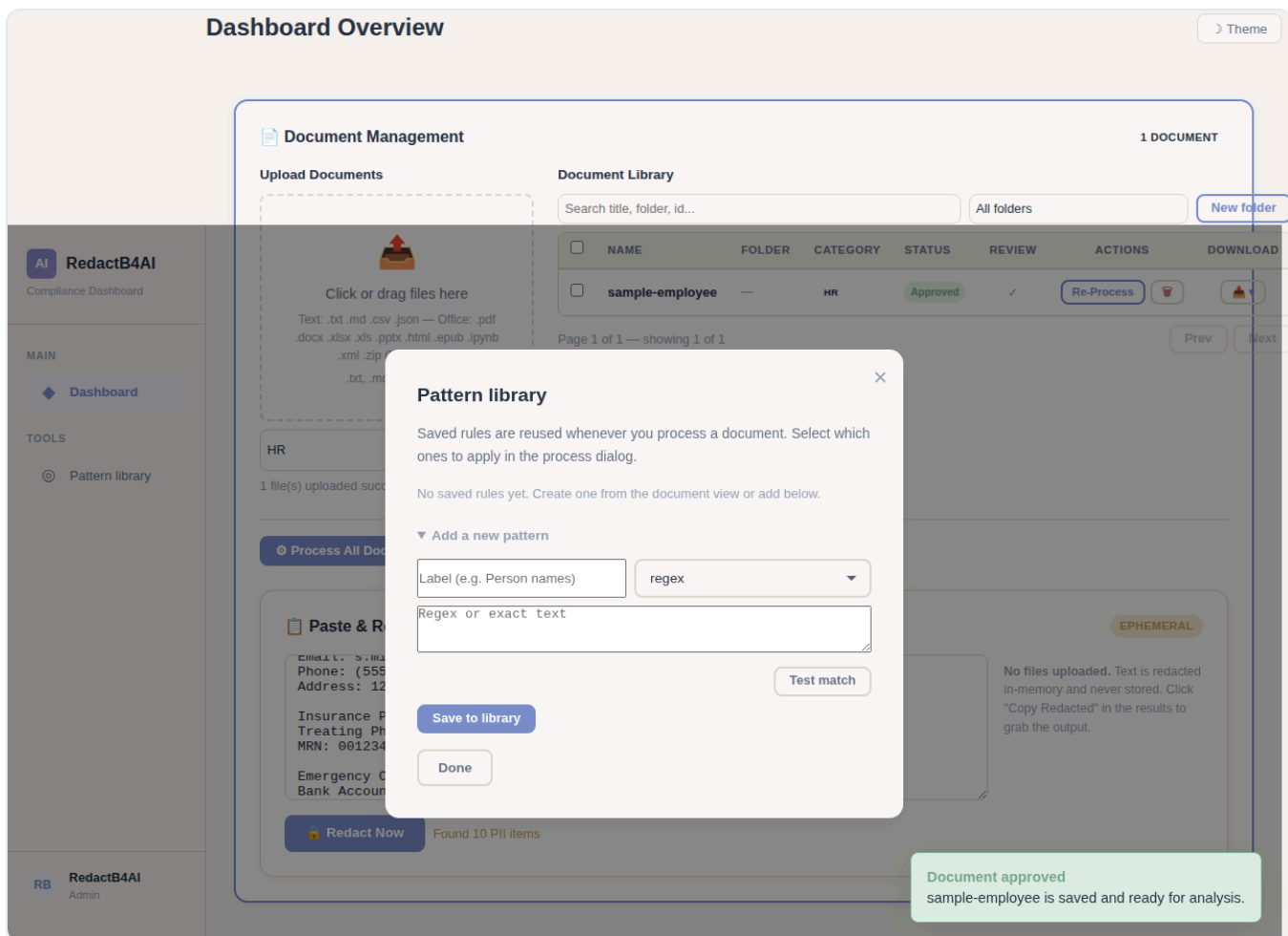
After you add a rule, the document re-processes automatically. The PII list updates with the new findings.

Step 5: Build Your Pattern Library

Every custom rule you create through the Pattern Lab gets saved to your Pattern Library. These rules stick around across sessions, so you only need to build them once.

View Your Library

Click **Pattern library** in the sidebar on the left.



You will see a list of all your saved rules, each showing:

- **Label:** a name you gave it (like "SSN pattern").
- **Kind:** whether it is a regex (pattern) or literal (exact text).
- **Body:** the actual pattern or text.

Add a Rule Manually

If you already know what pattern you need:

Click **Add a new pattern** in the Pattern Library.

Type a **Label** (like "Patient IDs").

Pick **regex** or **literal** from the dropdown.

Type the pattern or text.

Click **Test match** to see how many matches exist in the current document.

Click **Save to library**.

Use Saved Rules When Processing

When you click Process on a document, the Pattern Picker shows all your saved rules with checkboxes. Check the ones you want to apply on top of the built-in detection.

Step 6: Quick Redaction (Paste & Redact)

Sometimes you do not have a whole file. You just have a block of text and need it redacted fast.

Scroll to the **Paste & Redact** card on the dashboard.

Paste your text into the text area.

Click **Redact Now**.

Dashboard Overview

Theme

AI RedactB4AI

Compliance Dashboard

MAIN

Dashboard

TOOLS

Pattern library

RB RedactB4AI

Admin

Document Management

1 DOCUMENT

Upload Documents

Click or drag files here

Text: .txt, .md, .csv, .json — Office: .pdf, .docx, .xlsx, .xls, .pptx, .html, .epub, .ipynb, .xml, .zip (Markdown), .txt, .md, .csv, .json

HR

Scan Directory

1 file(s) uploaded successfully

Document Library

Search title, folder, id...

All folders

New folder

	NAME	FOLDER	CATEGORY	STATUS	REVIEW	ACTIONS	DOWNLOAD
☐	sample-employee	—	HR	Approved	✓	Re-Process	

Page 1 of 1 — showing 1 of 1

PrevNext

Process All Documents

Paste & Redact

EPHEMERAL

Employee: Jane Mitchell, 123 Main St, Springfield, IL 62701

Phone: (555) 234-8901

Address: 123 Main St, Springfield, IL 62701

Insurance Policy ID: ABC-12345678

Treating Physician: Dr. James Park

MRN: 00123456

Emergency Contact: Jane Mitchell, (555) 345-6789

Bank Account: 4455778899, Routing: 021000089

No files uploaded. Text is redacted in-memory and never stored. Click "Copy Redacted" in the results to

Document approved
sample-employee is saved and ready for analysis.

Redact Now

The processing modal opens with the original and redacted versions side by side.

Dashboard Overview

Document Management 1 DOCUMENT

Upload Documents Document Library

Search title, folder, id... All folders New folder

Paste & Redact Results 10 PII FOUND

Original	Redacted PII REMOVED	PII Detection
Patient Intake Form Patient Name: Sarah Mitchell Date of Birth: 01/15/1985 SSN: 478-55-3201 Email: s.mitchell@apex.com Phone: (555) 234-8901 Address: 123 Main St, Springfield, IL 62701 Insurance Policy ID: ABC-12345678 Treating Physician: Dr. James Park MRN: 00123456 Emergency Contact: Jane Mitchell, (555) 345-6789 Bank Account: 4455778899, Routing: 021000089	Patient Intake Form Patient Name: [PERSON-cc715a] Date of Birth: [DOB-1dab78] SSN: [SSN-f3bf68] Email: [EMAIL-009a39] Phone: [PHONE-ef69b2] Address: [ADDRESS-9421c5] Insurance [INSURANCE-7440ee] Treating Physician: [PROVIDER-3d7b6a] [MRN-0aadbc] Emergency Contact: Jane Mitchell, [PHONE-b41482] Bank Account: 4455778899, Routing: 021000089	Found 10 PII items PERSON NAME Sarah Mitchell → [PERSON-cc715a] DATE OF BIRTH 01/15/1985 → [DOB-1dab78] SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER 478-55-3201 → [SSN-f3bf68] EMAIL ADDRESS s.mitchell@apex.com → [EMAIL-009a39] PHONE NUMBER (555) 234-8901 → [PHONE-ef69b2] ADDRESS 123 Main St, Springfield, IL 62701 → [ADDRESS-9421c5] INSURANCE ID Policy ID: ABC-12345678 → [INSURANCE-7440ee] HEALTHCARE PROVIDER Dr. James Park → [PROVIDER-3d7b6a] MEDICAL RECORD NUMBER MRN: 00123456 → [MRN-0aadbc] EMERGENCY CONTACT (555) 345-6789 → [PHONE-b41482]

Review the redacted text and PII list. Approve when redaction looks complete, or flag missed items.

Missed Something Copy Redacted Text Close

Document approved
sample-employee is saved and ready for analysis.

Click **Copy Redacted Text** to grab the result.

Nothing gets saved to disk. This is for one-off, in-and-out redaction.

Step 7: Download Your Redacted Documents

After processing and approving a document, you can download it.

Single Document

Click the download button (down arrow) on a document row. Pick from:

- **Markdown:** downloads a `.md` file.
- **Original:** downloads the file in its original format (PDF, DOCX, etc.).

- **Redacted:** downloads the redacted version. The filename gets `- redacted` added to it.

Multiple Documents

Check the boxes next to several documents. A selection toolbar appears. Click **Download Markdown** or **Download Redacted**. Multiple files come as a ZIP.

Step 8: Batch Processing

Got a lot of documents? You can process them all at once.

Click **Process All Documents** in the Batch Actions bar.

The system runs PII detection on every document in the library and approves them automatically.

A status message tells you how many documents were processed and how many PII items were found.

This is the fastest way to redact an entire document set.

Step 9: Customize Your View

Toggle Dark Mode

Click the **Theme** button (moon icon) in the top-right corner to switch between light and dark mode. Your choice is saved for next time.

What Types of Personal Information Get Caught?

The built-in detector finds these automatically:

TYPE	EXAMPLE
Email addresses	<code>s.mitchell@apex.com</code>
Phone numbers	<code>(555) 234-8901</code>

TYPE	EXAMPLE
Social Security numbers	478-55-3201
Credit card numbers	4111-1111-1111-1111
IP addresses	192.168.1.50
Bank routing numbers	021000089
Bank account numbers	4455778899
Tax IDs	93-7654321
Insurance policy IDs	ABC-1234567
Healthcare NPI numbers	1234567890
Medical record numbers	12345678
Person names	Sarah Mitchell
Addresses	123 Main St
Dates of birth	01/15/1985
Patient/client IDs	98765
Case numbers	2024-001

You do not need to configure any of this. It runs on every document, every time.

Tips

- **Start small.** Process one document first to see how the detector works before running batch processing on everything.
- **Use folders.** Organizing documents by department or project makes it easier to find things later.
- **Build your pattern library over time.** Each time you catch something the system missed, save the rule. Next time, it catches that type automatically.

- **Paste & Redact is great for emails.** Got a forwarded email with personal info? Paste it in, redact it, copy the result, and send it.
- **Check the redacted output.** No detector is perfect. Always review the redacted version before sharing it.